
Joel Mbaka

Software Engineer

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<https://joelmbaka.com>

Professional Summary

Software Engineer specializing in React Native, Next.js, TypeScript, Python, and AI-powered product development. I help founders and early-stage startups **turn rough ideas into polished mobile and web applications**, from MVP planning and architecture to App Store/Play Store launch, backend systems, payments, analytics, and deployment.

I have built and shipped products including JournPad, RentPayor, Macsim Cargo, AI Stylist, and CliviQue HMIS, covering consumer mobile apps, SaaS dashboards, logistics workflows, rent reconciliation, and healthcare operations. My strength is moving fast without losing engineering discipline: clean product thinking, practical UX, reliable backend design, and the ability to own the full path from concept to production.

Core stack: React Native, Expo, Next.js, TypeScript, Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Firebase, Vercel, Docker, OpenAI APIs, App Store, and Google Play deployment.

Experience

Founder | JournPad: AI Voice Journal

SEP 2025 - PRESENT

Web: <https://journpad.com>

Store: [App Store](#) | [Google Play](#)

AI voice journal that turns spoken reflections into structured, searchable, and playable entries.

- Built and launched the mobile app with Expo, React Native, TypeScript, and RevenueCat subscriptions.
- Developed AI workflows for titles, summaries, categories, prompts, insights, and searchable journal entries.
- Shipped recording, playback, reminders, image attachments, kids mode, backend, and store releases.

Tech: Expo, React Native, TypeScript, Python, GCP, Docker, Firebase, RevenueCat, OpenAI APIs

Founder | RentPayor: Rent reconciliation for landlords

APRIL 2026 - PRESENT

Web: <https://rentpayor.com>

Store: [Link](#)

Rent reconciliation app that helps landlords match M-Pesa, bank, and cash payments against invoices, tenants, units, and leases.

- Built and launched the landlord mobile app with Expo, React Native, TypeScript, and Firebase authentication.
- Implemented property, unit, tenant, lease, invoice, and payment tracking workflows.
- Developed rent reconciliation, unmatched payment review, approval flows, backend services, and local CRM tooling.

Tech: Expo, React Native, TypeScript, Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Firebase, SQLAlchemy, OpenAI APIs

Software Engineer | Macsim Cargo Services

FEB 2026 - APR 2026

Web: <https://macsimcargo.com>

Store: [Link](#)

Logistics and cargo app for managing loads, fleet activity, driver workflows, bookings, documents, and operational updates.

- Built and shipped the mobile app with Expo, React Native, TypeScript, and Firebase authentication.
- Implemented admin and driver workflows for load booking, assignment, tracking, and trip status updates.
- Added document scanning, notifications, location-aware operations, and cargo workflow screens.
- Supported backend integration, Play Store assets, testing, and production delivery.

Tech: Expo, React Native, TypeScript, Python, FastAPI, Firebase, PostgreSQL

Education

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology, Nairobi

B.Sc Information Technology

Sep 2015 - Nov 2019

First Class Honors